

Dhāraṇī of the Noble Avalokiteśvara-Hayagrīva

Āryāvalokiteśvara-Hayagrīva-dhāraṇī · Toh 733 · Derge Kangyur

འཕགས་པ་སྐྱ་རས་གཟགས་དབང་ཕྱག་ཏུ་ཡ་གླིང་གི་ཟུས།

Toh 733 in the Kangyur is a dhāraṇī text known in Sanskrit as the Āryāvalokiteśvara-Hayagrīva-dhāraṇī and in Tibetan as the dhāraṇī of the noble Avalokiteśvara-Hayagrīva. It is a short ritual and devotional text centered on the bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara in his fierce horse-headed form as Hayagrīva, opening with an extended homage that praises him as a being of great compassion who protects sentient beings from fear, severs bonds, pacifies suffering, and holds mastery over all vidyā-kings. The text belongs to the dhāraṇī genre of the Kangyur, a class of works preserving sacred verbal formulas believed to concentrate and transmit the spiritual power of enlightened beings. It sits within the broader collection of dhāraṇī and mantra texts that form a significant portion of the Kangyur's ritual literature.

Here ends the noble dhāraṇī of the Glorious One (Yaśodharā).

In the language of India: Āryāvalokiteśvara-Hayagrīva-dhāraṇī. In the Tibetan language: The dhāraṇī of the noble Avalokiteśvara-Hayagrīva.

I bow to all buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Homage to the Three Jewels. Homage to the noble Avalokiteśvara, bodhisattva, great being, one of great compassion, who leads all sentient beings to safety, who carries all sentient beings away, who delivers all sentient beings from fear, who pacifies all existence, who arouses the awakening mind in all sentient beings, who severs all bonds, who pacifies all suffering, who dispels all darkness, who has attained mastery over all vidyā-kings, great lord of yoga and of yogins.

Having paid homage to him, I shall now proclaim this heart-essence that issues from the mouth of the noble Avalokiteśvara, which was revealed by the ṛṣi, and which is revered by gods, nāgas, yakṣas, rākṣasas, Śakra, Brahmā, the world-guardians, Viṣṇu, the Great God (Śiva), Nārāyaṇa, Skanda, Kubera, the lord of asuras, and the hosts of mothers. Homage having been made, together with Vajrakīla I shall recite Hayagrīva-Brahma, the supreme heart-essence.

O you who accomplish the immeasurably sublime purpose, who carry away all beings, who remove all obstacles and obstructing forces, who accomplish all actions infallibly, who disperse all poisons, who remove obstructing forces —

thus it is:

Oṃ taru lateru lateru la, bitaru la bitaru la. Destroyer of all poisons. You who drive away all spirits, blazing with fire, with flaming mane, with terrible laughter, with hair-tips glowing, O forest-dweller. You before whom the vajra-spike courses irresistibly, who strides freely, who gives abundantly, who breathes the vajra, who laughs, who is worshipped by the wind, who pacifies, who quells the evil obstructors, who annihilates them, who gives teachings well, who bestows supreme peace. Buddha, buddha — I awaken through you. O Bhagavān Hayagrīva, I shall recite the heart of all vidyā.

Devour, devour, O great wrathful one — through the mantra. Protect, protect all who are dear to oneself — through the mantra. Accomplish, accomplish — be accomplished for me in all actions. Come, come — enter, enter, appear, appear. Enter, enter into all grahas (planetary spirits) without obstruction. Shake, shake — disperse, disperse. Crush, crush — grind, grind. Annihilate all who engage in causing harm. You who have been seized by the kṛtyā, by the khorduru, by those in difficult straits — O mouse, O poison-maker with poison fangs, O you who pulverize poison, O you who drive away those who perform harmful rites with poison. O accomplished collyrium — you who bewitch the eyes, you who cause distraction of the mind, you who never cease to watch. Terrify, terrify, with the supernatural power of the great bodhisattva's fangs. Protect, protect all beings from all fears. O Buddha, Dharma, Saṅgha — approved by you, swiftly accomplish my karma. Phaṭ. Hayagrīva phaṭ. Vajrakīla phaṭ. Vajra-tusked, burst forth. O you of fearful and terrifying aspect, phaṭ. Destroyer of armor through the mantra, phaṭ. You who devour the evil obstructors, phaṭ. You who subdue all grahas, phaṭ. You who are unimpeded in all grahas, phaṭ. Root of the veil, phaṭ. Whatever enemies there may be who wish me ill, who cause harm through the body, who destroy with mantras, who come to subjugate with mantras, who summon, who act with khordi — all of them I refute with this mouth. Bound by speech, phaṭ. Homage to the subduing of all malevolent grahas. To Hayagrīva: may the mantra-words be accomplished. Svāhā. Oṃ amṛtodbhavāya hūṃ phaṭ phaṭ svāhā. Oṃ namo hayāya svāhā. Oṃ namo viśvamūrtaye svāhā. Homage — may all beings be accomplished through the mantra-words. Svāhā.

Here ends the dhāraṇī called the noble Avalokiteśvara-Hayagrīva.

Translator's Notes

- The opening line refers to "the noble Glorious One" whose dhāraṇī has just concluded — likely Yaśodharā or another deity whose dhāraṇī immediately precedes this text in the collection; the exact identity depends on the surrounding canonical context.

Several Sanskrit phrases within the mantra body are in damaged or non-standard orthography in the source, and some sequences resist clean grammatical parsing. The rendering follows the most philologically plausible reading while preserving the ritual structure. The term rendered "khordi" reflects a Tibetanized form that does not correspond to a clearly recoverable Sanskrit term and is left as a phonetic approximation.

The term "Vajrakīla" renders "vajrakhura" (literally "vajra-hoof"), an epithet also associated with Hayagrīva's horse nature, though in some contexts it overlaps with Vajrakīlaya. This is a significant doctrinal nuance left for specialists.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.